

The Cashew Seed

Once long ago, the animals in the forest decided to have a grand party.

Everyone was happy except a little cashew seed. It was sad because it could not see the celebration outside. In those days, a cashew seed grew inside the fruit.

"Oh, how I hate this **dingy** little room cried the cashew seed. "All I can see are these boring walls. If only I could live outside!

As soon as the seed **uttered** these words, the cashew fruit burst open. The seed **popped out, astonished** but **delighted** that its wish had come true. Then, just as suddenly as it had opened. The fruit closed. The little cashew seed was thrilled to find itself on the outside of the fruit. It watched the Animals singing and dancing with great joy.

"The world outside is so beautiful! the seed **sighed** happily.

When the festivities were over, the animals returned to their homes. Darkness **descended** and the cashew seed began to get **restless**.

"It has become **gloomy** here too, sighed the seed.

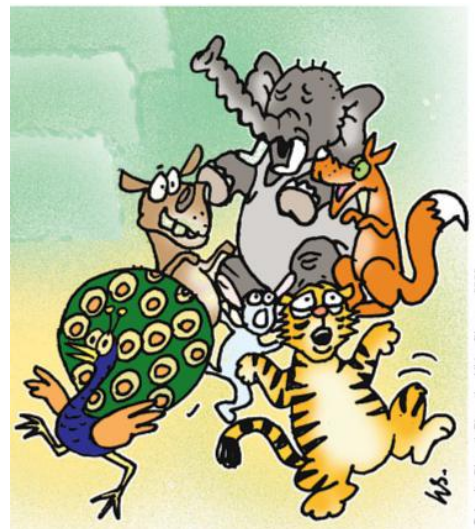
A cold wind **blew** suddenly. There was a **peal** of thunder **followed** by **streaks** of lightning and within seconds **torrential** rains came **pouring down**.

"Aaah! Ouch!" cried the seed, as the rains **lashed** it **mercilessly**.
"I'm so wet and cold! If only I could go back to my little room!"

But its wish went unheard. The fruit did not open up to let the seed in.

"If only I'd been **content** to remain where I was the seed thought in **remorse**.

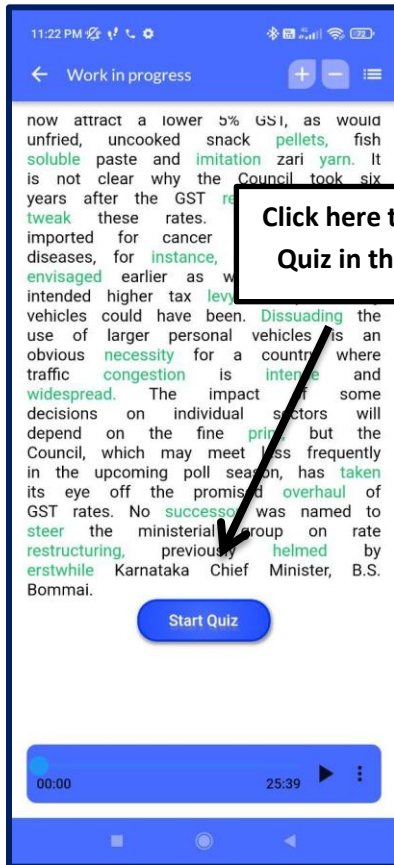
Since then, it is said, the cashew seed has always been growing outside the fruit never inside.



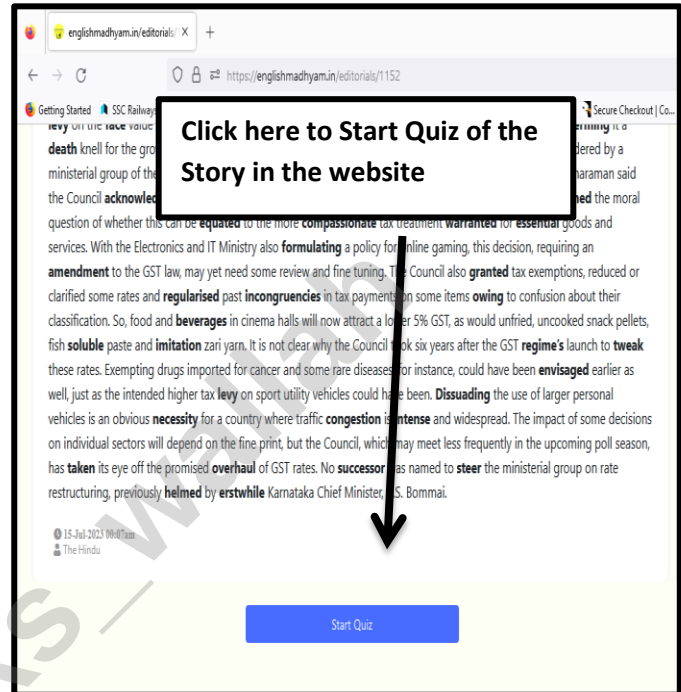
Vocabulary

1. **Dingy** (adjective) – dull, gloomy, shabby, dirty, dark गंदा और धुंधला
2. **Utter** (verb) – speak, say, express, articulate, pronounce बोलना / व्यक्त करना
3. **Pop out** (phrasal verb) – jump out, burst out, emerge, spring out, appear suddenly बाहर निकल आना
4. **Astonish** (verb) – amaze, surprise, stun, bewilder, shock आश्चर्यचकित करना
5. **Delight** (verb) – please, charm, gladden, amuse, exhilarate आनंदित करना
6. **Sigh** (verb) – exhale, breathe out, groan, murmur, moan आह भरना
7. **Descend** (verb) – fall, come down, drop, sink, settle नीचे उतरना
8. **Restless** (adjective) – uneasy, anxious, fidgety, impatient, agitated बेचैन
9. **Gloomy** (adjective) – dark, dull, depressing, cloudy, miserable उदास / अंधेरा
10. **Blow** (verb) – gust, puff, waft, rush, surge बहना (हवा का चलना)
11. **Peal** (noun) – burst, clap, boom, roll, rumble (of sound, especially thunder or laughter) गड़गड़ाहट
12. **Follow** (verb) – come after, trail, pursue, succeed, ensue पीछा करना / अनुगमन करना
13. **Streak** (noun) – flash, line, stripe, blaze, band चमकदार रेखा / चमक
14. **Torrential** (adjective) – heavy, intense, pouring, flooding, fierce मूसलधार
15. **Pour down** (phrasal verb) – rain heavily, drench, stream, fall hard, come down heavily तेज़ी से बरसना
16. **Lash** (verb) – strike, whip, beat, thrash, pelt मारना / कोड़े की तरह पड़ना
17. **Mercilessly** (adverb) – cruelly, harshly, brutally, pitilessly, relentlessly निर्दयता से
18. **Content** (adjective) – satisfied, happy, pleased, at ease, fulfilled संतुष्ट
19. **Remorse** (noun) – regret, guilt, repentance, sorrow, contrition पश्चाताप

Practice Exercise



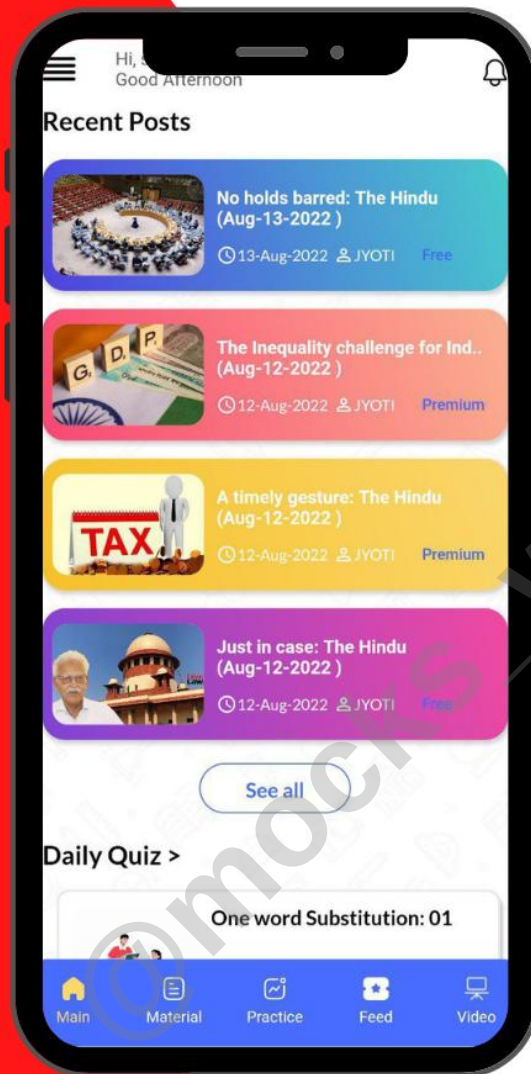
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